BCSE CLASS X
ENGLISH I

Writing & Grammar — Exam Notes with Solved Papers

Based on the BCSE English I papers of **2023, 2024 and 2025**

14 chapters · every chapter has a summary table, exam links to the papers, diagrams and fully solved questions

> **How to use these notes**
> Each chapter starts with a **"Must-know" table**, then shows **where it appeared in the papers** (tags like 2024 Q9), then gives **solved questions**. Answers are shown in **green underlined bold**. Learn the tables and diagrams, then cover the answers and re-attempt the questions.

Contents

All chapters in order, with page numbers

Chapter	What it covers / where it was asked	Page
Paper Pattern & Question Map	What the examiner asks — and how often	**3**
Chapter 1: Expository Essay	Q1 · 25 marks · 350–400 words · asked in 2023, 2024 and 2025	**5**
Chapter 2: Formal Letter	Q2 · 15 marks · one of two situations · asked in 2023, 2024 and 2025	**11**
Chapter 3: Report Writing	Q3 · 10–15 marks · asked in 2023 (picture), 2024 (facts table) and 2025 (programme)	**16**
Chapter 4: Table to Paragraphs (Data Interpretation)	Q4 · 10 marks · not more than 150 words · asked in 2025	**19**
Chapter 5: Confused Words, Homophones & Spelling	Section B · 2023 Q4, Q5(i) · 2024 Q9(ii) · 2025 Q9 · spelling is marked in every fill-in question	**21**
Chapter 6: Subject–Verb Agreement & Error Spotting	2023 Q7 [10] · 2024 Q5 [5], Q8 [5] · 2025 Q9 [10] — the highest-scoring repeated topic	**23**
Chapter 7: Modals, Conditionals & Verb Forms	2023 Q5(ii) · 2024 Q9(vi, viii) · 2025 Q5(i) · 2025 Q6 [5]	**26**
Chapter 8: Phrasal Verbs	2023 Q10 [5] · 2023 Q5(v) · 2024 Q4 [5] — learn the list below	**28**
Chapter 9: Idioms	2024 Q7 [5] · 2025 Q10 [5] · 2025 Q5(iii) — an idiom's meaning is NOT the meaning of its words	**30**
Chapter 10: Discourse Markers (Connectors)	2023 Q11 [5] · 2024 Q9(v, vii) · 2025 Q5(x)	**32**
Chapter 11: Parallelism, Word Order & Sentence Rearranging	2023 Q9 [5] · 2024 Q9(iii, iv) · 2024 Q8(ii) · 2025 Q9(9)	**34**
Chapter 12: Cloze Passages (Fill in the Blanks)	2023 Q6 [5] (The White-bellied Heron) · 2024 Q6 [10] (A House on Fire) · 2025 Q6 [5] (verb forms)	**36**
Chapter 13: Sentence Transformation — Reported Speech, Passive Voice & Special Patterns	2025 Q7 [5] · 2025 Q5(vi)	**38**
Chapter 14: Vocabulary, Crosswords & Grammar MCQs	2023 Q8 [5] · 2024 Q10 [5] · 2025 Q8 [5] · 2024 Q9 [10] · 2025 Q5 [10]	**41**
Last-Minute Revision Sheet	English I — everything on one page	**45**

Printing tip

Print double-sided on A4. Every chapter starts on a new page, so you can compile and re-arrange chapters in a file.

Paper Pattern & Question Map

What the examiner asks — and how often

1. Structure of the paper (2023 – 2025)

Section	2023	2024	2025
A: Writing	55 marks	55 marks	60 marks
Q1 Expository essay (350–400 words)	25	25	25
Q2 Formal letter (one of two)	15	15	15
Q3 Report writing	15 (picture, ~150 words)	15 (information table, 180–200 words)	10 (programme, 180–200 words)
Q4 Table → paragraphs (≤150 words)	–	–	10
B: Grammar	45 marks (Q4–Q11)	45 marks (Q4–Q10)	40 marks (Q5–Q10)

2. Topic-wise question map (where each topic appeared)

Topic / chapter	2023	2024	2025
Ch 1 Expository essay	Q1	Q1	Q1
Ch 2 Formal letter	Q2	Q2	Q2
Ch 3 Report	Q3 (picture)	Q3 (table of facts)	Q3 (programme)
Ch 4 Data → paragraph	–	–	Q4
Ch 5 Confused words & spelling	Q4, Q5(i)	Q9(ii)	Q9 (example)
Ch 6 Subject–verb agreement & error spotting	Q7	Q5, Q8	Q9
Ch 7 Modals, conditionals & verb forms	Q5(ii)	Q9(vi, viii)	Q5(i), Q6
Ch 8 Phrasal verbs	Q10, Q5(v)	Q4	–
Ch 9 Idioms	–	Q7	Q10, Q5(iii)
Ch 10 Discourse markers	Q11	Q9(v, vii)	Q5(x)
Ch 11 Parallelism & sentence rearranging	Q9	Q9(iii, iv)	–
Ch 12 Cloze passages	Q6	Q6	Q6 (verb forms)
Ch 13 Transformation: passive, reported speech, inversion	–	–	Q7, Q5(vi)
Ch 14 Vocabulary, crosswords & MCQ grammar	Q8, Q5(iii, iv)	Q10, Q9(i, ix, x)	Q5(ii, iv–ix), Q8

Priority list (appears EVERY year)

Expository essay • formal letter • report • error identification (correct/incorrect or find-the-error) • phrasal verbs / idioms / discourse markers (at least one every year) • MCQs on modals, parallelism, homophones and question tags.

Rules printed on the papers (never break them)

• Do **NOT** write your real name, school, or any detail that discloses your identity — the answer may be **cancelled**. Use only the names given in the question (Dhendup, Sonam, Lhamo…).

• MCQs: circle only **ONE** letter — two circles = zero marks.

• Cloze / rearranging: use only ONE word per blank; spelling errors lose marks. Rearrange questions need **all** given words.

• Error-identification: correct **only the error**; do not rewrite the whole sentence.

Chapter 1: Expository Essay

Q1 · 25 marks · 350–400 words · asked in 2023, 2024 and 2025

1.1 Must-know summary

Point	What to remember
What is an expository essay?	An essay that **explains, informs or discusses** a topic using facts, reasons and examples. It does not tell a story and it does not simply argue "for/against".
Instruction words in the papers	*How has…?* (cause–effect) • *Explain THREE benefits* (exactly three) • *The value of…* (importance) • *Discuss its impacts* (effects) • *The role of…* • *The importance of…*
Marks are given for	(1) orderly and coherent presentation of **content**, (2) **essay features** (introduction, body, conclusion, topic sentences, linking words), (3) **accuracy of grammar** and spelling.
Length	350–400 words ≈ 5 paragraphs ≈ 3 pages of the answer booklet. Too short loses content marks; too long wastes time.
Structure	Introduction (60–80 words) → 3 body paragraphs (80–90 words each) → Conclusion (50–60 words).
Tense & person	Mostly **simple present**, third person (people, youth, Bhutan). Avoid "I", "you" and slang.
Do NOT	Mention your name, school, village, teacher or any detail that identifies you → the answer can be **cancelled**.

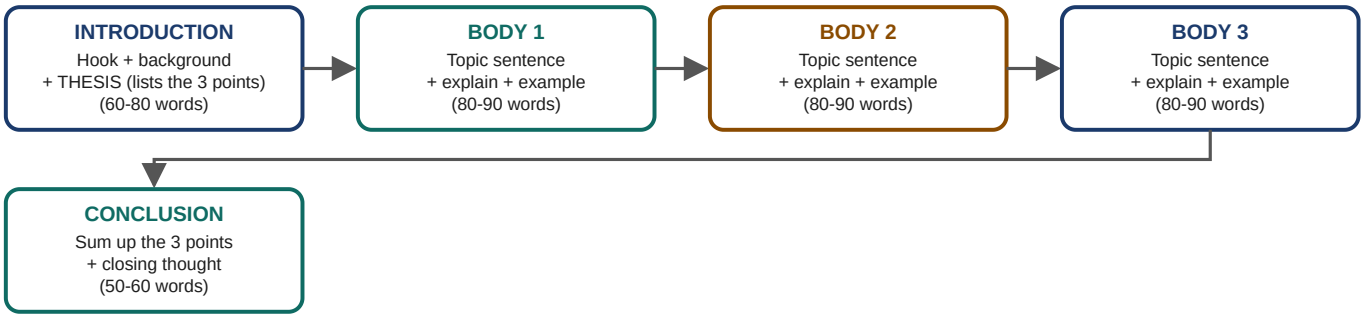


Fig 1.1 Plan of a 5-paragraph expository essay (use this for every topic)

1.2 Useful linking words

Purpose	Words / phrases
Starting points	Firstly / First of all / To begin with · Secondly · Thirdly · Finally
Adding	Moreover · In addition · Furthermore · Likewise · Besides
Examples	For example · For instance · such as · as seen in
Cause & effect	As a result · Therefore · Consequently · This leads to · Because of this
Contrast	However · Although · On the other hand · Despite this
Concluding	In conclusion · To sum up · Thus · Overall

1.3 Exam link — all six essay questions asked

Year	Option (a)	Option (b)	Type of question
2023	How has social media become a major cause of insecurities among today's youth?	Explain THREE benefits for Bhutan if people chose electric vehicles over fossil-fuel vehicles.	(a) cause–effect · (b) three benefits
2024	The value of honouring our tradition in the modern world.	Adolescents are at risk from cyberbullying. Discuss its impacts.	(a) importance · (b) effects
2025	The role of young people in the economic, social and political growth of a country.	The importance of resilience, teamwork and communication for succeeding in life.	(a) three areas · (b) three qualities

Pattern spotted

Almost every topic has a **built-in "three"** (3 benefits, 3 areas, 3 qualities, or cause/effect you can split into 3). Make each of the three your body paragraphs. One topic is always about **Bhutan / youth / technology** — keep local examples ready (gho & kira, tshechu, hydropower, De-suung, democracy 2008, carbon-negative).

1.4 Solved questions (model essays)

These are model answers to learn from. Do not memorise word for word — learn the plan and the examples, then write in your own words.

2023 Q1(a) How has social media become a major cause of insecurities among today's youth? [25]

Plan: Intro → (1) constant comparison → (2) unrealistic beauty standards & likes = self-worth → (3) cyberbullying & fear of missing out → Conclusion.

Social Media and the Rise of Youth Insecurity

Social media has changed the way young people communicate, learn and entertain themselves. Platforms such as Facebook, Instagram and TikTok connect teenagers with friends and celebrities within seconds. However, behind the smiling photographs and the number of likes lies a growing problem. Social media has become a major cause of insecurity among today's youth because it encourages endless comparison, promotes unrealistic standards of beauty, and exposes young people to cyberbullying and the fear of missing out.

Firstly, social media breeds insecurity through constant comparison. Users usually post only the best moments of their lives, such as holidays, new clothes and celebrations. When a teenager scrolls through these polished pictures, he or she begins to feel that his or her own life is dull and inadequate. For instance, a student who sees classmates posting photographs from expensive trips may feel poor or left behind. Over time, such comparisons weaken self-confidence and make young people dissatisfied with what they have.

Secondly, filters and edited photographs create unrealistic standards of beauty. Many youth believe that the flawless faces and perfect bodies they see online are real. As a result, they become unhappy with their own appearance, and some even starve themselves or depend on expensive cosmetic products to look "perfect". Likewise, the number of likes and followers has become a measure of self-worth. A teenager whose post receives only a few likes may wrongly conclude that he or she is unpopular or unattractive.

Thirdly, social media exposes the youth to cyberbullying and the fear of missing out. Hurtful comments, rumours and embarrassing photographs can spread rapidly and remain online for years, leaving victims anxious and ashamed. In addition, when young people see their friends attending parties without them, they fear being excluded. This fear compels them to stay online constantly, which disturbs their sleep, studies and real-life relationships.

In conclusion, although social media offers many benefits, its careless use has made many young people feel inadequate, lonely and anxious. Parents and teachers should guide the youth to use these platforms wisely, while the youth themselves must remember that online lives are rarely the full truth. By valuing real friendships and their own talents, they can enjoy technology without losing their confidence.

≈ 368 words

2023 Q1(b) Explain THREE benefits for Bhutan if her people chose to use electric vehicles over fossil-fuel vehicles. [25]

Plan: Intro → (1) saves foreign currency / uses our own hydropower → (2) protects environment (carbon-neutral pledge) → (3) health & quiet towns → Conclusion.

Why Bhutan Should Choose Electric Vehicles

Bhutan is proudly carbon negative, yet the number of petrol and diesel vehicles on its roads grows every year. Since all fuel has to be imported, switching to electric vehicles (EVs) would be one of the wisest decisions the nation could make. If the Bhutanese people chose electric vehicles over fossil-fuel vehicles, the country would benefit in three important ways: it would save foreign currency, protect the environment, and improve public health and well-being.

The first and most obvious benefit is economic. Bhutan has no oil of its own and spends a large amount of its hard-earned foreign currency, mainly Indian rupees, on importing petrol and diesel. Electric vehicles run on electricity, and Bhutan produces plenty of clean hydropower. By charging vehicles with domestic electricity, the country would reduce its fuel import bill and keep that money at home. Moreover, EV owners would spend less on running costs because electricity is cheaper than fuel and electric motors need less maintenance than engines.

The second benefit is environmental protection. Petrol and diesel vehicles release carbon dioxide and other harmful gases that pollute the air and contribute to global warming. Electric vehicles produce no exhaust emissions. Since Bhutan's electricity comes from rivers rather than coal, the vehicles would run on truly clean energy. This would help Bhutan to keep its promise to remain carbon neutral for all time and to protect its forests, glaciers and rivers, which are the foundation of its tourism and agriculture.

The third benefit relates to health and quality of life. Smoke and dust from vehicles in busy towns such as Thimphu and Phuentsholing cause coughing, asthma and other breathing problems, especially among children and the elderly. EVs would clean the air in these crowded places. They are also much quieter than conventional vehicles, so towns would have less noise pollution. A cleaner and calmer environment would help people to live healthier and more peaceful lives, and would make Bhutan even more attractive to visitors.

In conclusion, electric vehicles offer Bhutan a rare chance to save money, protect nature and improve the health of its citizens at the same time. The government can support this change through subsidies, charging stations and awareness programmes, but the real change must come from the people. By choosing electric vehicles, every Bhutanese can contribute to a greener and more self-reliant nation.

≈ 389 words

2024 Q1(a) The value of honouring our tradition in the modern world. [25]

Plan: Intro → (1) identity → (2) moral values & harmony → (3) economy (tourism, Zorig Chusum) → tradition + technology together → Conclusion.

The Value of Honouring Our Tradition in the Modern World

Bhutan is a small Himalayan kingdom, but its culture is rich and unique. Every day we see people wearing the gho and kira, greeting elders with respect and celebrating tshechus with joy. Today, however, television, the internet and fast-changing lifestyles are pulling the young generation towards foreign ways. In such a time, honouring our tradition is not outdated; it is essential because it gives us our identity, teaches us moral values, supports our economy and connects one generation to the next.

First, tradition gives a people their identity. A nation without its culture is like a tree without roots. Our national dress, language, architecture and festivals show the world who we are. When a young Bhutanese proudly wears the gho or kira to school and the dzong, he or she carries a sense of belonging and pride. In a globalised world where people are becoming alike, this identity helps us to stand apart and to remain confident about ourselves.

Second, traditions teach values that modern life often forgets. Customs such as driglam namzha, respect for parents and elders, and sharing food and labour with neighbours build harmony and kindness in society. Religious practices and festivals bring families and villagers together and remind us of compassion, gratitude and the law of cause and effect. These values guide the youth to become responsible citizens, which no machine or application can teach.

Third, tradition contributes to our economy. Thousands of tourists visit Bhutan every year to witness our tshechus, see our dzongs and buy handwoven textiles, thangkas and wood carvings from the thirteen traditional arts and crafts, the Zorig Chusum. These skills create jobs for artisans, farmers and guides, especially in rural areas. If we neglect our traditions, we will lose both our culture and a valuable source of income.

Finally, honouring tradition does not mean rejecting modernity. We can use technology to record folk songs, teach dances online and promote our crafts to the world. The wise path is to take the best from the modern world while keeping our roots firm. In conclusion, tradition is the foundation upon which a strong and happy nation stands, and it is the duty of every Bhutanese to protect it and pass it on to future generations.

≈ 372 words

2024 Q1(b) Adolescents are at risk from cyberbullying. Discuss its impacts. [25]

Plan: Intro (define cyberbullying) → (1) mental health → (2) studies → (3) body & social life, lasting online record → Conclusion with solutions.

The Impacts of Cyberbullying on Adolescents

Adolescence is a sensitive stage of life when young people are searching for their identity and acceptance. With smartphones and social media in almost every teenager's hand, this stage now has a new danger: cyberbullying. It means harassing, insulting or threatening someone through messages, posts, photographs or videos online. Unlike traditional bullying, it follows the victim home, can be anonymous and spreads quickly. Its impacts on adolescents are serious and affect their mind, body, studies and relationships.

The most serious impact is on mental health. Victims often feel ashamed, helpless and afraid because insulting messages can be seen by hundreds of people. They may develop anxiety, depression and low self-esteem, and may begin to believe the cruel things said about them. In extreme cases, the pain becomes so unbearable that some adolescents think of hurting themselves or even ending their lives.

Cyberbullying also damages academic performance. A student who is constantly worried about the next hurtful message cannot concentrate in class. Many victims lose interest in lessons, skip school to avoid classmates and see their marks fall. Teachers may mistake this sudden change for laziness, and the real cause remains hidden.

Moreover, it affects physical health and social life. Stress leads to headaches, stomach aches, loss of appetite and sleepless nights. Socially, victims withdraw from friends and family, stop taking part in sports or cultural activities and prefer to remain alone. Some even respond with anger and become bullies themselves, which continues the cycle. Another cruel feature is that humiliating posts may stay on the internet for years and harm a person's reputation in the future.

To protect adolescents, parents should talk openly with their children and monitor online activities with care. Schools must run awareness programmes and offer counselling, and victims should save evidence, block the bully and report to a trusted adult or the authorities. Young people must also think before they post, because a single careless comment can hurt a life. In conclusion, cyberbullying is a silent but dangerous threat, and only the combined efforts of families, schools and the youth themselves can make the internet a safe place for everyone.

≈ 354 words

2025 Q1(a) The role of young people in the economic, social and political growth of a country. [25]

Plan: Intro (youth = present and future) → (1) economic: workforce, innovation, start-ups → (2) social: volunteering, awareness, culture → (3) political: democracy, voting, future leaders → Conclusion.

The Role of Young People in a Country's Growth

Young people are often called the future of a nation, but in truth they are also its present. In Bhutan, a large part of the population is under thirty, and their energy, ideas and skills can shape the direction of the country. Young people play vital roles in the economic, social and political growth of a nation, and a country that guides and trusts its youth moves forward with confidence.

Economically, the youth are the main workforce and the source of innovation. They bring new ideas, learn technology quickly and start small businesses in areas such as farming, tourism, handicrafts and information technology. When a young person starts a cafe, a poultry farm or a mobile application, he or she not only earns a

living but also creates jobs for others and reduces unemployment. Educated youth who return to farming or work in the hydropower and service sectors also help the nation to depend less on imports and foreign aid.

Socially, young people are the energy behind change. They volunteer in clean-up campaigns, blood donation drives, tree-plantation programmes and community service, as seen in the De-suung programme and school clubs of Bhutan. Through social media and school activities, they spread awareness about drugs, mental health, gender equality and the environment. They also carry our culture forward by learning traditional arts, speaking our languages and celebrating our festivals, so that our identity is never lost.

Politically, the youth help to strengthen democracy. Bhutan became a democracy in 2008, and its success depends on citizens who are informed and responsible. Young voters can question leaders, vote carefully and take part in debates and youth forums. Many will one day become leaders, civil servants and lawmakers themselves, so the habits of honesty, dialogue and respect for the law that they develop now will decide the quality of tomorrow's governance.

However, young people can succeed only when they receive quality education, skills training and opportunities. Elders and the government must listen to them, while the youth must remain disciplined and committed. In conclusion, the economic prosperity, social harmony and political stability of a country largely depend on its youth, and by investing in them a nation invests in its own future.

≈ 367 words

2025 Q1(b) The importance of resilience, teamwork and communication for succeeding in life. [25]

Plan: Intro (three legs of a stool) → (1) resilience → (2) teamwork → (3) communication → how the three connect → Conclusion.

Resilience, Teamwork and Communication: Keys to a Successful Life

Success in life rarely comes from talent alone. A student may be intelligent, yet fail to progress if he or she gives up after the first failure, cannot work with others or cannot express ideas clearly. Three qualities, namely resilience, teamwork and communication, work together like the three legs of a stool to support a successful life. Each of them is explained below.

Resilience is the ability to recover from setbacks and keep trying. Life is full of disappointments, such as a low score in an examination, a lost match or a rejected application. Resilient people treat these as lessons rather than the end of the road. For example, a student who fails a test and studies harder the next time will eventually improve. Great achievers, such as sportspeople and scientists, often failed many times before succeeding. Resilience also protects mental health because it helps us to handle stress and disappointment calmly.

Teamwork is the ability to work with others towards a common goal. Most big achievements, from building a dzong to winning a football tournament, need many people with different skills. In a team, members share work, support one another and combine ideas so that the result is better than what one person could achieve alone. Teamwork also teaches us patience, responsibility and respect for different opinions, which are needed at school, at the workplace and at home.

Communication means expressing our thoughts clearly and listening carefully to others. Good communication avoids misunderstandings, builds trust and helps us to solve problems peacefully. A student who can speak confidently in an interview, write a clear letter and listen to a teacher's advice has a great advantage. In a team, communication is what holds members together, because plans cannot be carried out if nobody knows what others are doing.

These three qualities are closely connected. Communication allows a team to share its plans, teamwork gives each member support, and resilience helps the group to rise again after failures. In conclusion, anyone who wishes to succeed in education, work and life should develop all three, for knowledge alone cannot carry a person very far.

≈ 352 words

Self-check before you submit

☐ Title given ☐ 5 paragraphs ☐ each body paragraph starts with a topic sentence ☐ at least one example per paragraph ☐ linking words used ☐ no personal/school details ☐ check subject–verb agreement, spelling and punctuation.

Chapter 2: Formal Letter

Q2 · 15 marks · one of two situations · asked in 2023, 2024 and 2025

2.1 Must-know summary

Part	What to write
Sender's address	Top (right or left): the writer's designation, organisation and place. Use only the details given in the question (e.g. Principal, Pemacholing Central School, Dagana).
Date	Below the sender's address, e.g. 12 September 2023.
Receiver's address	Designation (The Manager / The Regional Transport Officer), organisation, place — on the left.
Salutation	**Dear Sir/Madam,** (Dear Sir, if the officer is clearly male). Never "Hi" or first names.
Subject line	One line that states the purpose: Request for supply of items for school variety show.
Body	**Para 1:** purpose of writing **Para 2:** details / reasons / items / dates **Para 3:** clear request or action wanted + polite closing.
Closing	**Yours faithfully,** (when you used "Dear Sir/Madam") + signature + name + designation.
Language	Formal, polite, no contractions (*do not*, not *don't*), no slang, short clear sentences. Phrases: *I am writing to… • I would be grateful if you could… • kindly arrange… • I look forward to your reply.*
Length	About 170–200 words (15 lines of the answer booklet). Every point in the question must be covered — examiners tick them off.

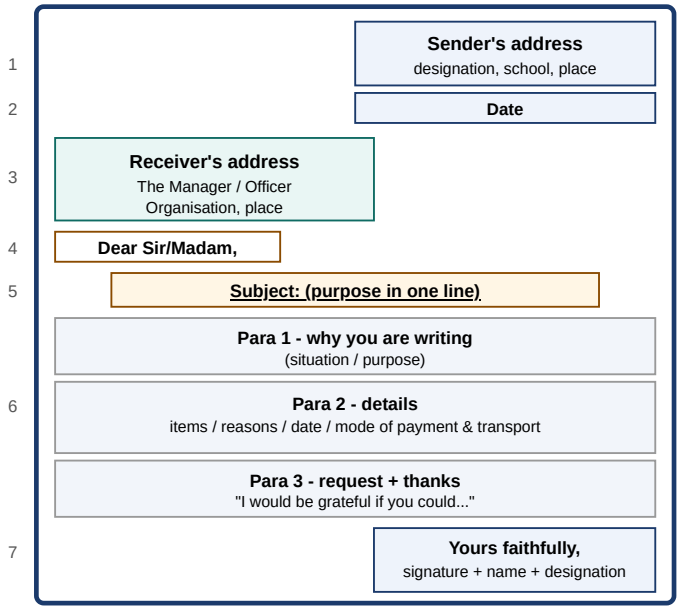


Fig 2.1 Layout of a formal letter (numbers show the order in which the parts are written)

2.2 Exam link — letters asked

Year	Situation (a)	Situation (b)	Type
2023	Principal Dhendup → Regional Transport Officer (RSTA): heavy traffic outside the school gate	Principal Dhendup → Manager, Druk Culture Store, Thimphu: items for variety show	(a) complaint/request for action · (b) order/request for supply

2024	Sonam (Peaceful Trails, Bumthang) → Principal: new one-day educational tour package	Tshering (STEM club captain) → Manager, Natsho Enterprise, Gasa: supply order for science exhibition	(a) promotion/information · (b) supply order
2025	Lhamo (class captain) → Proprietor, Delek Electronics: smart screen stopped working — ask replacement	Lhamo → Manager, Healthy and Fit Sports Club: seeking approval to join	(a) complaint/replacement · (b) request for membership

Four letter types that keep repeating

1) **Complaint / request for action** • 2) **Order / supply request** (items + quantity + date + payment + transport) • 3) **Information / promotion** (explain a package, fee, benefits) • 4) **Application / permission**. For an order letter, the question tells you exactly which points to include — give each one its own sentence.

2.3 Solved letters

2023 Q2(a) Principal Dhendup writes to the Regional Transport Officer (RSTA) about the danger and commotion caused by heavy traffic outside the school gate. [15]

Principal
Pemacholing Central School
Dagana
12 September 2023

The Regional Transport Officer
Road Safety and Transport Authority (RSTA)
Regional Office

Dear Sir,

Subject: Request for traffic control measures outside the school gate

I am writing to bring to your kind notice the dangerous traffic situation outside the main gate of Pemacholing Central School, Dagana, and to request your urgent action.

In recent years a new settlement has come up near the school, and the number of vehicles, shops and people along the road has grown rapidly. As a result, the road in front of our gate is badly congested, especially between 8:00 and 9:00 in the morning and between 3:30 and 4:30 in the evening. Taxis, buses and private cars park carelessly, the pavement is blocked, and hundreds of students have to squeeze through the crowd and cross the road. Several near accidents have already occurred, and the younger children are most at risk.

I would therefore be grateful if you could (i) post a traffic officer near the gate during the peak hours, (ii) install speed breakers, a zebra crossing and warning signs, and (iii) mark a separate parking and drop-off area away from the school entrance.

I am confident that your prompt action will protect the lives of our children. I would be happy to meet you or your officials to discuss the matter further. Thank you for your kind attention.

Yours faithfully,
Dhendup
Principal, Pemacholing Central School, Dagana

2023 Q2(b) Principal Dhendup writes to the Manager, Druk Culture Store, Thimphu requesting supply of items for a school variety show (items, date of show, transport, payment). [15]

Principal
Pemacholing Central School
Dagana
12 September 2023

The Manager
Druk Culture Store
Thimphu

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Request for supply of items for the school variety show

Our school is organising an annual variety show on **25 November 2023** to showcase the talents of our students in dance, music and drama. I am writing to request you to supply the following items, which are needed for the performances:

1. Thirty sets of gho and kira in different sizes for the folk dances; 2. Ten traditional masks and costumes for the mask-dance item; 3. Four dramyens, two drums and five pairs of cymbals for the music items; 4. Twenty kabneys and rachus; and 5. Stage props and costume jewellery for the drama.

As Dagana is far from Thimphu, kindly send the items by a goods truck so that they reach the school by **15 November 2023**; the transport charges may be added to the bill. We shall make the payment through online bank transfer within a week of receiving the items against a proper bill. Please also send us a quotation in advance.

I look forward to your kind cooperation and a favourable reply. Thank you.

Yours faithfully,
Dhendup
Principal, Pemacholing Central School, Dagana

2024 Q2(a) Sonam of Peaceful Trails (Bumthang) writes to the Principal of Yeshey Central School about a new one-day educational tour package; the fee is reasonable and food is included. [15]

Sonam
Peaceful Trails, Tour Operators
Bumthang
4 October 2024

The Principal
Yeshey Central School
Bumthang

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: New educational tour package for students

I am writing on behalf of Peaceful Trails, a tour operating agency based in Bumthang, to inform you about our new educational tour package designed especially for school students.

The package offers a one-day visit to the holy sites of our dzongkhag, namely Jambay Lhakhang, Kurjey Lhakhang, Tamshing Lhakhang and Jakar Dzong. A trained local guide will explain the history, legends and religious importance of each place, so that the students learn about our culture in a real setting. The tour begins at 8:00 a.m. and ends at 5:00 p.m., and safe transport and first-aid support are provided.

The fee is very reasonable at **Nu. 600 per student**, and this amount **includes a hot lunch and evening tea**. We also offer free entry for one teacher for every ten students. I believe that this tour would be a valuable learning experience for your students.

If you are interested, kindly let us know a convenient date at least one week in advance. I would be glad to visit your school to explain the package in detail. Thank you for your time.

Yours faithfully,
Sonam
Peaceful Trails, Bumthang

2024 Q2(b) Tshering, STEM club captain, writes to the Manager of Natsho Enterprise, Gasa to place a supply order for a science exhibition (items, quantity, mode of payment, transportation). [15]

Tshering, Captain
STEM Club, Norzoe Academy
Gasa
8 October 2024

The Manager
Natsho Enterprise
Gasa

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Order for equipment for the science exhibition

Our school is organising a science exhibition on **2 November 2024**, and as the captain of the STEM club I have been asked to place a supply order for the equipment needed. I am writing to request you to supply the following items:

1. Fifteen electric circuit kits (bulbs, switches and holders); 2. Twenty packets of AA batteries; 3. Ten rolls of insulated copper wire; 4. Ten magnifying glasses; 5. Fifty sheets of chart paper; and 6. Ten packets of coloured marker pens.

Kindly deliver the items to our school by your own vehicle on or before **28 October 2024**, as we need time to prepare the models. The school will make the payment by account-payee cheque on delivery after checking the items against your bill. Please send us a quotation of the total cost before delivery, and a discount would be much appreciated since the items are for educational use.

I would be grateful for your prompt reply and cooperation. Thank you.

Yours faithfully,
Tshering
Captain, STEM Club, Norzoe Academy, Gasa

2025 Q2(a) Lhamo (class captain) writes to the proprietor of Delek Electronics, Zhemgang: the smart screen stopped functioning within two weeks; ask for a free replacement with clear reasons. [15]

Lhamo, Class Captain
Class X, Trong Middle Secondary School
Zhemgang
20 September 2025

The Proprietor
Delek Electronics
Zhemgang

Dear Sir,

Subject: Request for replacement of a defective smart screen

I am writing on behalf of my classmates to inform you that the smart screen we bought from your shop on 2 September 2025 has stopped working, and to request you to replace it without any additional charge.

My classmates and I collected Nu. 45,000 from our own pocket money to buy this screen for our classroom. It was installed on 4 September, but within two weeks the picture began to flicker and then the screen went completely blank. We have used it only for lessons, under the care of our teachers, so the fault cannot be due to misuse. Since the screen is new and was covered by your warranty, I believe the problem is a manufacturing defect. Moreover, our teachers can no longer use it for presentations, which is badly affecting our studies.

I therefore request you to replace the screen with a new one within a week. A copy of the bill and the warranty card is enclosed. We will be happy to show the screen to your technician at any time.

I hope you will treat this matter as urgent and help us. Thank you for your kind understanding.

Yours faithfully,
Lhamo
Class Captain, Class X

2025 Q2(b) Lhamo has moved to a new neighbourhood and writes to the Manager of Healthy and Fit Sports Club, Zhemgang seeking approval to join, explaining her interest. [15]

Lhamo
Class X, Trong Middle Secondary School
Zhemgang
20 September 2025

The Manager
Healthy and Fit Sports Club
Zhemgang

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Request for approval to join the sports club

I am writing to request your kind approval to join the Healthy and Fit Sports Club. I have recently moved to a house near your club, and I would very much like to become a member.

I have always been interested in sports, especially basketball and badminton, and I represented my class in several inter-class matches. Regular exercise keeps me active and helps me to concentrate better on my studies. As a class X student, I do not have enough opportunity to practise properly at school, and your club offers good facilities and trained coaches. I believe that joining the club would improve my skills as well as my fitness and discipline.

I can attend the club between 4:30 and 6:30 in the evening on weekdays and the whole morning on holidays, so my studies will not be affected. My parents have given their permission. I would be grateful if you could tell me about the membership fee, rules and timings, and the documents I need to submit.

I look forward to your favourable reply. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,
Lhamo

Common mistakes in letters

• Writing your **real** name/school → cancellation. • "Dear Sir/Madam" + "Yours sincerely" (mismatch: with Sir/Madam use *faithfully*). • Missing subject line. • Forgetting one of the required points (date, transport, payment, quantity). • Informal words (*kids*, *stuff*, *gonna*). • Not ending with a clear request.

Chapter 3: Report Writing

Q3 · 10–15 marks · asked in 2023 (picture), 2024 (facts table) and 2025 (programme)

3.1 Must-know summary

Feature	What to do
Purpose	To give an **accurate, factual account** of an event (or a picture) for readers of a newspaper, school magazine or club.
Headline	Short, catchy, in capital or title case: *Blood Donation Camp Held at Gyelzang HSS*.
By-line & dateline	*By Pema, Executive Reporter, Nyetshuel* | *Thimphu, 14 November 2024:* (place + date).
Paragraph 1 (lead)	Answer the 5Ws + H: **What** happened, **Who** organised/took part, **Where**, **When**, **Why** (purpose), and **How**.
Middle paragraphs	Details in order: programme, numbers, activities, what officials/participants said (reported speech).
Last paragraph	Result / impact / what happens next / thanks.
Tense & voice	**Past tense** (the camp *was organised*) • often **passive** • **third person** • no personal opinion (*I think, I felt*).
Word limit	2023: ~150 words • 2024 & 2025: **180–200 words**. Use **all** the given information (names, numbers, date, purpose).
Picture-based report	Describe what you can see (who/what/where), infer the cause (heavy rain → landslide), add reasonable details (officials, action taken), keep it realistic.



Fig 3.1 The "inverted pyramid" of a news report — most important facts first

3.2 Useful words & phrases

Use	Examples
Opening	*was organised / was held / took place / was conducted at… on… to…*
Participation	*A total of… took part • were present • attended • participated enthusiastically*
Reporting speech	*The principal said that… • According to the organisers… • He urged everyone to…*
Closing	*The programme ended with… • The organisers thanked… • It is hoped that…*

3.3 Exam link

Year	Task	Given information
2023 Q3 [15]	Kencho, reporter, *News Today* (Zhemgang branch): study the picture and write a report in ~150 words	Picture: landslide blocking a road, car stuck in mud, excavator, bus beyond the debris, people looking on
2024 Q3 [15]	Pema, executive reporter of *Nyetshuel*: report on a blood donation camp (180–200 words)	Donors: 150 students + 30 teachers • Place: Gyelzang Higher Secondary School • Purpose: voluntary blood contribution for medical purposes • Duration: one day, 14 Nov 2024 • Organiser: JDWNRH
2025 Q3 [10]	Sonam, class X, Gadhen Central School, Trashigang, UNESCO Club coordinator: report on the recent tree plantation programme (180–200 words)	No facts given — you must invent **sensible** details (date, saplings, who helped)

> **When no facts are given (2025)**
> You may create realistic details: number of saplings, species (blue pine, cypress, walnut), helpers (Forest Office, local Gup, teachers), purpose (green cover, soil erosion, awareness), and what will happen next. Keep numbers small and believable.

3.4 Solved reports

2023 Q3 **Picture report (about 150 words) — Kencho, reporter, News Today, Zhemgang. [15]**

Landslide Blocks Highway; Travellers Stranded

By Kencho, News Today, Zhemgang

Zhemgang: A massive landslide blocked a section of the highway in Zhemgang yesterday, leaving many vehicles and passengers stranded for several hours.

The landslide occurred early in the morning after heavy rain loosened the soil on the steep hillside. Large rocks, mud and uprooted trees spilled across the road and completely cut off the traffic. A car got stuck in the thick mud, while a bus and other vehicles waited helplessly on the far side. Some passengers walked carefully over the slippery debris to see how bad the situation was.

Soon after receiving the information, a team from the Department of Roads reached the spot with an excavator and began clearing the debris. The workers also warned people to stay away from the unstable slope. Officials said that the road would be opened to light vehicles by evening, and they advised drivers to travel carefully during the monsoon.

≈ 153 words

2024 Q3 **Blood donation camp (180–200 words) — Pema, executive reporter of Nyetshuel. [15]**

Blood Donation Camp Held at Gyelzang Higher Secondary School

By Pema, Executive Reporter, Nyetshuel

Thimphu, 14 November 2024: A one-day blood donation camp was organised by Jigme Dorji Wangchuck National Referral Hospital, Thimphu, at Gyelzang Higher Secondary School today to facilitate the voluntary contribution of blood from eligible students and teachers.

A total of 180 donors, including 150 students and 30 teachers, took part in the camp. The programme began in the morning with a short talk by a doctor, who explained the importance of blood donation and how one donation can save several lives. Donors were first checked for weight, haemoglobin level and blood pressure, and only healthy and eligible persons were allowed to donate. Trained nurses collected the blood under hygienic conditions, and the donors were given refreshments and rest afterwards.

The principal said that blood donation is a noble act and thanked the hospital team for visiting the school. A Class X student who donated for the first time said that he felt proud to help save lives. The blood collected will be sent to the hospital's blood bank for patients who need transfusion, such as accident victims and mothers during childbirth. The hospital team urged everyone to donate blood regularly.

≈ 195 words

2025 Q3 Tree plantation programme (180–200 words) — Sonam, UNESCO Club coordinator, Gadhen Central School, Trashigang. [10]

UNESCO Club Plants Trees to Protect the Environment

By Sonam, UNESCO Club Coordinator, Gadhen Central School

Trashigang, 21 June 2025: The UNESCO Club of Gadhen Central School organised a tree plantation programme in the nearby community on Saturday to increase the green cover and to create awareness about protecting the environment.

About sixty students, teachers and community members took part in the programme. The Dzongkhag Forest Office provided 300 saplings of blue pine, cypress and walnut and guided the participants on the correct way of planting. The programme began with a short talk by the local Gup, who reminded everyone that trees prevent soil erosion and landslides, keep the air clean and provide shelter to wildlife. The volunteers then dug pits on a barren slope above the village, planted the saplings, watered them and protected each one with a fence of bamboo and branches.

Every club member adopted a sapling and promised to look after it throughout the year. The villagers appreciated the effort of the students and offered to help in watering the plants during the dry season. The club plans to monitor the saplings regularly and to organise more such programmes in the future.

≈ 188 words

Mistakes to avoid

• Writing a story or personal diary (*I woke up…*) • Missing the headline/by-line • Leaving out a given fact (e.g. 150 students **and** 30 teachers) • Mixing tenses • Writing under/over the word limit.

Chapter 4: Table to Paragraphs (Data Interpretation)

Q4 · 10 marks · not more than 150 words · asked in 2025

4.1 Must-know summary

Step	What to do
1. Read the table	Title, units (%), years, categories, source. Here: *Enrolment in Secondary Education by Age* — right age (IX = 14 yrs, X = 15 yrs), overage, underage for 2022 and 2023, plus the average.
2. Introduction	One sentence: what the table shows, which years/classes.
3. Main body	Group the data: one paragraph per category. Quote key figures, compare classes and years (increase / decrease).
4. Conclusion	Overall trend in one sentence.
5. Rules	Present or past tense (past for past years) • formal tone • no personal opinion • **no copying every number** — pick the important ones • stay under 150 words.

Describing change	Words
Up	increased / rose / went up / grew — *from 15.50% to 24.15%*
Down	decreased / fell / dropped / declined
Size of change	slightly • steadily • sharply • considerably
Comparing	higher / lower than • whereas • in contrast • while • the majority / a small proportion

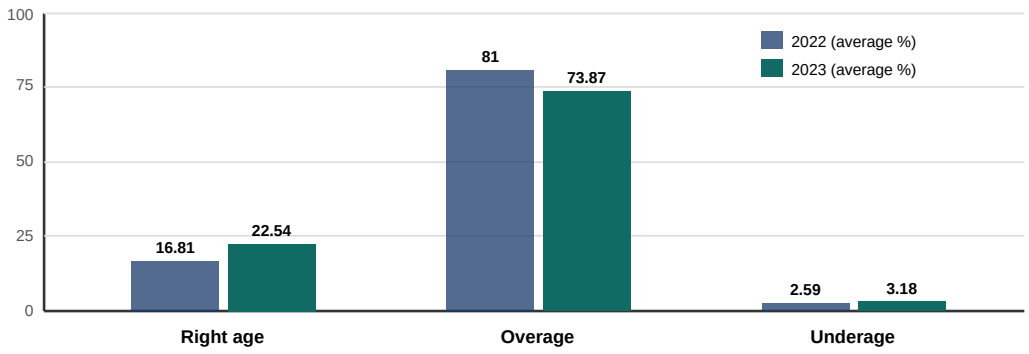


Fig 4.1 The 2025 table drawn as a bar chart (average of Classes IX and X). Seeing the pattern first makes the paragraph easy: right age ↑, overage ↓, underage slight ↑.

4.2 Solved question

2025 Q4 Study the table "Enrolment in Secondary Education by Age" and transfer the information into paragraphs using not more than 150 words. [10]

The table shows the percentage of Class IX and X students who were of the right age, overage and underage in 2022 and 2023. The right age is 14 years for Class IX and 15 for Class X.

Right-age students increased in both classes: from 15.50 to 24.15 per cent in Class IX and from 18.12 to 20.94 per cent in Class X, raising the average from 16.81 to 22.54 per cent.

In contrast, overage students declined. They fell from 82.68 to 72.48 per cent in Class IX and from 79.32 to 75.26 per cent in Class X. Underage students remained very few, though their average rose slightly from 2.59 to 3.18 per

cent.

Overall, more students entered secondary school at the proper age in 2023, but overage students were still the majority.

≈ 145 words

Chapter 5: Confused Words, Homophones & Spelling

Section B · 2023 Q4, Q5(i) · 2024 Q9(ii) · 2025 Q9 · spelling is marked in every fill-in question

5.1 Must-know summary

> **Rule of thumb**
>
> **Homophones** sound alike but have different spellings and meanings (*weather/whether*). **Confused words** look or sound similar (*accept/except*). **Word-form pairs** are the same root in a different part of speech (*confident* = *adjective, confidence* = *noun*). First decide the **part of speech** needed in the blank, then choose.

Pair	Meaning & example	Paper
weather / whether	*weather* = climate (noun): "bad weather". *whether* = if / or not: "whether it rains or not".	2023 Q4
confident / confidence	*confident* (adj.) = self-assured — goes after *seem, feel, be*. *confidence* (noun) = self-belief.	2023 Q4
fair / fare	*fair* = just / light-coloured / a fair (event). *fare* = money paid for transport.	2023 Q4
accept / except	*accept* (verb) = receive willingly. *except* = apart from.	2023 Q4
gate / gait	*gate* = entrance. *gait* = the way a person walks.	2023 Q4
site / sight / cite	*site* = place/location. *sight* = something seen / vision. *cite* = quote as evidence.	2024 Q9
affect / effect	*affect* = verb (influence); *effect* = noun (result).	
principal / principle	*principal* = head of school / main; *principle* = rule or belief.	
stationary / stationery	*stationary* = not moving; *stationery* = pens, paper.	
advice / advise	*advice* = noun; *advise* = verb.	
complement / compliment	*complement* = completes; *compliment* = praise.	
lose / loose	*lose* = misplace/fail to win; *loose* = not tight.	
then / than	*then* = at that time/next; *than* = comparison.	
its / it's	*its* = possessive; *it's* = it is / it has.	
their / there / they're	possession / place / they are.	
quiet / quite	*quiet* = silent; *quite* = fairly.	
past / passed	*past* = time before / beyond; *passed* = verb (V2/V3 of pass).	
breath / breathe	noun / verb.	
to / too / two	preposition / also, excessively / number.	

Spelling tips

Tip	Examples
i before e, except after c	re**ce**iving (not ~~recving~~), be**lie**ve, ach**ie**ve, dec**ei**ve

Double the consonant before -ing/-ed (short vowel)	brag → brag**g**ing, run → run**n**ing, plan → plan**n**ed
Drop silent -e before -ing	receive → receiv**ing**, write → writ**ing**, embody → embod**ying** (y stays after a consonant + -ing)
Words often misspelt in the papers	~~athelete~~ → athlete • ~~Amoung~~ → Among • ~~embeding~~ → embodying • ~~restorant~~ → restaurant • ~~receiving~~ → receiving • ~~childs~~ → children
Other tricky words	separate, definitely, necessary, environment, government, occurrence, embarrass, accommodation, tomorrow, beautiful, calendar, vegetable

5.2 Solved questions

2023 Q4 **Choose the correct answer from the brackets and write it in the blank. [5]**

No.	Sentence with answer	Why
i	Whatever the **weather** condition, the game will not be cancelled.	"weather condition" = noun for climate; *whether* would need "or not".
ii	Both the children seemed very **confident** before their performance.	After *seemed* + *very* we need an adjective.
iii	The park visitors complained that the **fare** of the safari bus ride was too expensive.	Money paid for a ride = fare.
iv	All the girls **except** for Dechen decided to turn down the invitation.	Dechen is excluded from "all the girls" → except.
v	Due to his unsteady **gait** he decided not to walk on the narrow bridge.	Unsteady manner of walking = gait.

2023 Q5(i) **Which of the following is spelt incorrectly? A reciving B bragging C possessive D witnessing [1]**

Answer: **A — "reciving"** (correct spelling: *receiving*; "i before e except after c").

2024 Q9(ii) **The _____ provided a beautiful _____ of the valley. A cite, site B sight, site C site, sight D cite, sight [1]**

Answer: **C — site, sight**. "The **site** (place) provided a beautiful **sight** (view) of the valley."

2025 Q9 (example) **"The restorant had a great atmosphere and delicious food." — correct or incorrect?**

INCORRECT — *restorant* → *restaurant* (given as the worked example).

Chapter 6: Subject–Verb Agreement & Error Spotting

2023 Q7 [10] · 2024 Q5 [5], Q8 [5] · 2025 Q9 [10] — the highest-scoring repeated topic

6.1 Must-know summary: agreement rules

#	Rule	Example (from the papers in bold)
1	The verb agrees with the **head noun**, not the noun next to it.	**The slaughter** of tigers for their bones and fur has caused controversy. • **The presence** of certain bacteria in our bodies is…
2	**Neither…nor / either…or / not only… but also**: the verb agrees with the **nearer** subject.	Neither the lab assistant nor the **students** were able…
3	**Each, every, everyone, either, neither, one** + singular verb.	Each person who climbs… mentions… • Each of the players has…
4	**Collective nouns** (group, team, class, committee) are usually singular.	Does that group of scientists think…?
5	**as well as / along with / together with / in addition to** do not make the subject plural.	Kuenden, as well as his classmates, was expecting…
6	**A pair of / a number of / a bunch of**: "*A pair* of shoes is enough" (pair = singular). "A number of students are" (plural), "The number of students is" (singular).	Example in 2023 Q7
7	"**One of the** + plural noun" → verb is singular; but "one of the factors **that determine**" → verb after *that* is plural.	One of the factors that determine our health.
8	**Uncountable nouns** (news, information, advice, furniture) have no plural and no "a/an".	He was expecting great news (not ~~a great news~~).
9	Singular-looking nouns: news, mathematics, physics, measles; plural-only: scissors, trousers, people, police.	The news is good. • The police are here.

Error-spotting checklist (use in this order)

Step	Look for	Typical error
1	Subject–verb agreement	was/were, has/have, do/does, mention/mentions
2	Tense & time words	*Last year* + doesn't → didn't; *will* + V1 (not eaten)
3	Verb form (V1/V2/V3/-ing)	going to be ~~place~~ → placed; will ~~eaten~~ → eat
4	Singular/plural nouns & articles	a huge ~~numbers~~; one of the hottest ~~district~~; ~~childs~~
5	Comparatives/superlatives	~~hotter~~ → hottest (*among all*)
6	Pronouns / relative pronouns	The woman ~~which~~ → who; each… ~~their~~ → his/her
7	Parallel structure	~~to ride~~ horses → riding (see Ch 11)
8	Spelling & capital letters	~~Amoung~~, ~~emboding~~, ~~india~~, ~~mahal~~

6.2 Solved questions

2023 Q7 **Each sentence has an error. Identify and correct it (do not rewrite the whole sentence). [10]**

No.	Sentence	Error	Answer	Rule
Ex	A pair of shoes are enough for this trip.	are	is	pair = singular
i	He has been preparing dinner for a huge numbers of devotees every evening.	numbers	**number**	"a huge number of" (singular after *a*)
ii	Neither the lab assistant nor the students was able to download the information.	was	**were**	nearer subject *students* is plural
iii	Each person who climbs the hundred steps to the top mention the beautiful view.	mention	**mentions**	each person = singular
iv	The slaughter of tigers for their bones and fur have caused controversy.	have	**has**	head noun *slaughter* = singular
v	The presence of certain bacteria in our bodies are one of the factor that determines our overall health.	are	**is**	head noun *presence* = singular. (Also: *one of the factors that determine* — mention if space allows.)
vi	The students are going to be place in four main groups after the registration.	place	**placed**	passive: be + V3
vii	Among all the years, 2022 was the hotter year in Bhutan.	hotter	**hottest**	superlative for 3+ (*among all*)
viii	Do that group of scientists think robots would take over the humans?	Do	**Does**	group = singular
ix	As per the new schedule, the workers will eaten their food in the evening.	eaten	**eat**	will + base verb
x	Last year Sonam doesn't pay much attention to her studies.	doesn't	**didn't**	past time (*last year*) → didn't + V1

2024 Q5 **Edit the paragraph — one error in each line; identify and correct. [5]**

Text	Error	Correction
In an increasing volatile world, the United (example)	increasing	increasingly
Nations organization play a pivotal role in maintaining	play	**plays** (subject *organization* is singular)
global peace and security. Amoung the nations	Amoung	**Among** (spelling)
contributing to this novel cause, Bhutan	novel	**noble** (a "noble cause"; *novel* = new)
stands tall, emboding the spirit of	emboding	**embodying** (embody → embodying)
compassion, dedication, and professionalism.	This line has **no clear error**: the series is correctly punctuated and parallel (all nouns). If one must be given, the likely intended slip is the capital letter in "United Nations Organization" in line 2.	

2024 Q8 **State which sentences are CORRECT or INCORRECT. [5]**

No.	Sentence	Answer	Reason
i	Sarpang is one of the hottest district in Bhutan.	INCORRECT	one of the hottest **districts** (plural after "one of the")
ii	He liked being a winner and to be captain of the team.	INCORRECT	not parallel: being a winner and **being** captain
iii	Kuenden, as well as his classmates, was expecting a great news from their class teacher.	INCORRECT	"news" is uncountable (no *a*); *their* → *his* (refers to Kuenden)
iv	While I was running along the road, a dog bit me.	CORRECT	past continuous + simple past: correct
v	The woman which works here is from South Korea.	INCORRECT	for people use **who**/that, not *which*

2025 Q9 **State which sentences are CORRECT or INCORRECT. [10]**

No.	Sentence	Answer	Reason / correction
1	The Taj mahal is one of the most famous landmarks in india.	INCORRECT	proper nouns need capitals: **Taj Mahal**, **India**
2	She wanted to go for a walk, but it started to rain.	CORRECT	—
3	The childs are playing football in the park.	INCORRECT	irregular plural: **children**
4	Cinderella wore a beautiful dress to the party.	CORRECT	—
5	Notwithstanding her good conduct, she was unable to please her father.	CORRECT	*Notwithstanding* = despite
6	What a wonderful sight.	CORRECT	An exclamation; best punctuated with "!" but no grammar error
7	I did not met the manager yesterday.	INCORRECT	did not + base verb: **did not meet**
8	He wanted three things out of his job: satisfaction, a good salary, and recognition.	CORRECT	parallel nouns
9	Pema enjoys hiking, swimming, and to ride horses.	INCORRECT	parallelism: hiking, swimming and **riding** horses
10	Each of the players have their own locker.	INCORRECT	each = singular: **Each of the players has his/her** own locker

Chapter 7: Modals, Conditionals & Verb Forms

2023 Q5(ii) · 2024 Q9(vi, viii) · 2025 Q5(i) · 2025 Q6 [5]

7.1 Must-know summary: modal verbs

Modal	Use	Example
can / could	ability, permission; *could* = past ability / polite request	There was a time when I **could** stay up very late. 2024 Q9(viii)
may / might	possibility, permission (formal)	It **may** rain tonight.
will / would	future, decision made now, certainty; *would* = polite / past habit / result in conditionals	It is snowing, so I **will** stay at home. 2024 Q9(vi) • She **will** definitely like it! 2025 Q5(i)
shall / should	*shall*: offers/suggestions with I/we; *should* = advice, duty	Shall we go? • You **should** exercise.
must / have to	strong necessity / strong deduction	Students **must** wear uniform.
ought to	moral duty	We **ought to** respect elders.

> **Trick**
> A modal is always followed by the **base verb** (V1) — *will eat*, never ~~will eaten~~ / ~~will eats~~.

7.2 Conditional sentences

Type	If-clause	Main clause	Meaning / example
Zero	if + present simple	present simple	general truth: If you heat ice, it melts.
First	if + present simple	will + V1	real future possibility: If it rains, we will stay home.
Second	if + past simple	would + V1	unreal/imaginary present: If I were a bird, I would fly.
Third	if + past perfect (had + V3)	would have + V3	impossible past: If she had worked hard, she would have won.
Mixed	if + past perfect	would + V1	past cause → present result: She **wouldn't be** a top-level athlete now if she **hadn't worked** hard. 2023 Q5(ii)

7.3 Tenses at a glance

	Past	Present	Future
Simple	worked	work / works	will work
Continuous	was/were working	am/is/are working	will be working
Perfect	had worked	has/have worked	will have worked
Perfect continuous	had been working	has/have been working	will have been working

Use of simple present (2025 Q6)	Rule
Habits and routines (*every morning*)	he/she/it → verb + **s/es**: Pem Zam **runs**; she **focuses**

After *prefers to*, *wants to*, *to*	base form: prefers to **enjoy**
Subject = singular noun phrase (*balance*)	singular verb **is**

7.4 Solved questions

2023 Q5(ii) **She wouldn't be a top-level athlete now if she _____ worked hard. A didn't B hadn't C couldn't D shouldn't [1]**

Answer: **B — hadn't** (mixed conditional: *if* + *had* + *V3* for the past cause; *wouldn't be* for the present result).

2024 Q9(vi) **It is snowing outside, so I _____ stay at home. A can B may C will D must [1]**

Answer: **C — will** (a decision taken at the moment of speaking).

2024 Q9(viii) **There was a time when I _____ stay up very late. A can B could C would D might [1]**

Answer: **B — could** (past ability; *can* is present tense).

2025 Q5(i) **This dress suits her style. She _____ definitely like it! A can B will C may D could [1]**

Answer: **B — will** (*definitely* shows certainty; *may/could/can* show only possibility).

2025 Q6 **Choose the correct verb form. [5]**

Every morning, Pem Zam **runs** along the road to refresh herself before heading to work. She prefers to **enjoy** the fresh air and the peaceful environment. After her run, she feels energized and ready to tackle the day. At work, she **focuses** on her tasks and completes them efficiently. In the evening, she relaxes by reading a book. She **believes** that maintaining a good balance between work and leisure **is** essential for a healthy lifestyle.

Reasons: *every morning* + she → runs; *prefers to* + base verb → enjoy; she → focuses / believes; "maintaining a good balance" is one thing → is.

Chapter 8: Phrasal Verbs

2023 Q10 [5] · 2023 Q5(v) · 2024 Q4 [5] — learn the list below

8.1 Must-know summary

A **phrasal verb** = verb + preposition/adverb that together have a **new meaning** (*call off* = cancel). Learn the meaning, not the words separately. Questions ask you either to **fill a blank** from a box (2023) or to replace an underlined phrase with a phrasal verb (2024).

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example	Paper
call off	cancel	The principal had to call off the meeting.	2024
call for	require / demand	This problem calls for quick action.	2023
grow up	become an adult	He grew up in Bumthang.	2024
watch out	be careful / vigilant	Watch out for speeding vehicles.	2024
do away with	get rid of / abolish	Do away with negative thoughts.	2024
give up	stop trying / quit	Never give up your dreams.	2024
count on	rely on	You can count on me.	2024
drop out	leave school / a course	Many students drop out after Class X.	2024
turn down	reject / refuse	He turned down the scholarship.	2024
go through with	proceed with / carry out	They decided to go through with the demolition.	2024
back down	give in / withdraw a claim	She refused to back down.	2024
keep off	stay away from	Keep off the grass.	2023
put off	postpone	Don't put off your homework.	2023
go off	explode / ring (alarm) / go bad	The firecrackers will go off with a bang.	2023
run out (of)	be used up / finished	We ran out of time.	2023
look up	search for information	Look up the word in the dictionary.	2023
pull through	survive / recover from difficulty	Teamwork helped us pull through.	2023
cast aside	throw away / abandon	Cast aside your fear.	2023
put up	build / display / provide lodging	They put up a tent.	2023
bring up	raise (a child / a topic)	She did not want us to bring up that subject.	2023
get by	manage with difficulty	I can get by on this salary.	2023 Q5(v)
take on	accept (a task)	He took on extra work.	
get on	make progress / be friendly	How are you getting on?	
look after / look into	take care of / investigate	Look after your health.	
give in	surrender	He gave in at last.	
break down	stop working / collapse	The bus broke down.	

carry out	perform / complete	They carried out the plan.	
come across	find by chance	I came across an old photo.	
find out	discover	Find out the truth.	
set up	establish	They set up a club.	
put up with	tolerate	I cannot put up with noise.	
take after	resemble (family)	She takes after her mother.	
turn up / run into	arrive / meet by chance	He turned up late.	
pass away	die (polite)	His grandfather passed away.	
bring about	cause	Technology brought about changes.	

8.2 Solved questions

2023 Q10 **Fill in the blanks with the phrasal verbs in the table (keep off, call for, put off, go off, run out, look up, pull through, cast aside, put up, bring up). [5]**

No.	Sentence
i	The sign-board outside the house said to **keep off** the property.
ii	Team work helped us **pull through** the difficult phase of our lives.
iii	Tshering has to **cast aside** his fear if he wants to succeed in the game.
iv	The firecrackers will **go off** with a bang any moment now.
v	My mother did not want any one of us to **bring up** the conversation on pocket money.

Unused: call for, put off, run out, look up, put up.

2023 Q5(v) **As a music instructor, I _____, though I would like a better salary. A take by B take on C get by D get on [1]**

Answer: **C — get by** (manage to live on a small income). "take by" does not exist; *take on* = accept work; *get on* = progress.

2024 Q4 **Replace the underlined phrase with a phrasal verb from the table (call off, grow up, watch out, do away with, give up, count on, drop out, turned down, go through with, back down). [5]**

No.	Sentence	Answer
i	If you want to live in peace, you have to put an end to negative thoughts.	**do away with**
ii	You better be vigilant for speeding vehicles.	**watch out**
iii	My parents decided to proceed with the demolition of our ancestral house.	**go through with**
iv	He rejected the scholarship from the Regional Business College.	**turned down**
v	The principal had to cancel the meeting because of some urgent matters.	**call off**

Unused: grow up, give up, count on, drop out, back down.

Chapter 9: Idioms

2024 Q7 [5] · 2025 Q10 [5] · 2025 Q5(iii) — an idiom's meaning is NOT the meaning of its words

9.1 Must-know summary

An **idiom** is a fixed expression whose meaning is figurative. Questions: choose the meaning from two options (2024), or match the idiom in Column A to its meaning in Column B (2025). Use the **context** of the whole sentence: *Dawa was on cloud nine after winning — he felt happy*.

Idiom	Meaning	Example	Paper
spill the beans	reveal a secret	Tshomo spilled the beans about the surprise party.	2024 / 2025
on cloud nine	extremely happy	Dawa was on cloud nine after winning.	2024
give (someone) the cold shoulder	ignore deliberately	He gave me the cold shoulder.	2024
pass off as	pretend to be	Namgay passed himself off as a noble man.	2024
die in harness	die while still working / doing one's duty	Many soldiers died in harness.	2024
(his) bark is worse than his bite	threatens a lot but is harmless	Kelly is all bark and no bite.	2024
under the weather	feeling ill	My mom was a bit under the weather.	2025
through thick and thin	in good times and bad times	My friends are there through thick and thin.	2025
cut corners	do something cheaply / reduce expenses or effort	I cut corners to buy a gift.	2025
run on fumes	keep going while exhausted	After 12 hours of work, she was running on fumes.	2025
hit the books	study hard	It is time to hit the books.	2025 Q5
break the ice	start a conversation in an awkward situation	A joke broke the ice.	
a piece of cake	very easy	The test was a piece of cake.	
once in a blue moon	very rarely	We meet once in a blue moon.	
a blessing in disguise	something bad that turns out good	Losing that job was a blessing in disguise.	
let the cat out of the bag	reveal a secret by mistake	He let the cat out of the bag.	
beat around the bush	avoid the main point	Stop beating around the bush.	
burn the midnight oil	work/study late at night	I burned the midnight oil before exams.	
call it a day	stop working for the day	Let's call it a day.	
cost an arm and a leg	be very expensive	The phone cost an arm and a leg.	
bite the bullet	face a difficult thing bravely	She bit the bullet and told the truth.	
hit the nail on the head	say exactly the right thing	You hit the nail on the head.	
kill two birds with one stone	achieve two aims with one action	Walking to school saves money and keeps me fit.	
out of this world	excellent / wonderful	The song is out of this world!	2023 Q8

break the news (to)	tell someone important news	He hasn't broken the news to his mother.	2023 Q8
night owl	a person who stays awake late	Pem is a night owl.	2023 Q8
sold out	no copies left	The book was already sold out.	2023 Q8

9.2 Solved questions

2024 Q7 Choose and underline the correct meaning of the idiom. [5]

No.	Sentence	Answer
i	Dawa was **on cloud nine** after winning the competition. He was feeling extremely *lucky / happy*.	**happy**
ii	He gave me the **cold shoulder**. It was a shock to be *ignored / scolded* by someone close.	**ignored**
iii	Namgay **passed off himself** as a noble man. His neighbours knew that he was *pretending to be / regarded as* one.	**pretending to be**
iv	Many soldiers sought to **die in harness**. It meant to die *with dignity while carrying out the duty / with least injuries*.	**with dignity while carrying out the duty**
v	Kelly is all **bark and not bite**. Her threats are potentially *dangerous / harmless*.	**harmless**

2025 Q10 Match each sentence in Column A with the meaning in Column B. [5]

No.	Idiom (Column A)	Answer	Meaning
i	My mom was feeling a bit under the weather.	**c**	feeling ill
ii	My friends are always there for me through thick and thin.	**g**	in both good and bad times
iii	I often cut corners in order to buy something for my brothers.	**j**	reduce expenses
iv	She spilled the beans about the upcoming party.	**b**	revealed a secret
v	After working for 12 hours straight, she was running on fumes.	**e**	very tired and exhausted

Unused: a) becoming nervous, d) good luck, f) very easy, h) extremely happy, i) being very careful with every word and action.

2025 Q5(iii) The expression "hit the book" means, to … A enjoy reading B start writing books C attend a school-related event D immerse oneself in academic study [1]

Answer: **D — immerse oneself in academic study** ("hit the books" = study hard).

Chapter 10: Discourse Markers (Connectors)

2023 Q11 [5] · 2024 Q9(v, vii) · 2025 Q5(x)

10.1 Must-know summary

Discourse markers are words/phrases that link ideas between sentences and show the relationship (addition, contrast, result…). To choose the right one: **read both parts of the sentence and ask "what is the relationship?"**

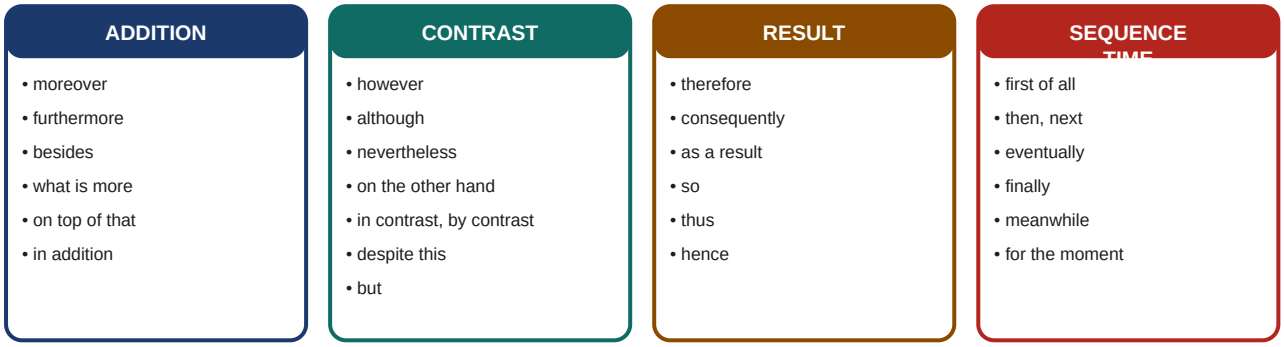


Fig 10.1 Discourse markers grouped by function

Function	Markers	Clue in the sentence
Addition	besides, moreover, what is more, on top of that, in addition	a second, similar point
Contrast	however, but, although, in contrast to, on the other hand, nevertheless	two opposite ideas
Cause / Result	therefore, consequently, as a result, so, thus	second part is the result of the first
Reason	because, since, as, due to	gives the cause
Time / Sequence	eventually (after a long time), meanwhile (at the same time), then, finally, for the moment (for now)	order of events / simultaneous events
Topic change	by the way, incidentally	an unrelated question or remark
Limiting	at least, in particular, especially	reduces or focuses a statement
Summary	in conclusion, to sum up, in other words	closing / restating

10.2 Solved questions

2023 Q11 **Underline the correct discourse marker. [5]**

No.	Sentence	Answer	Why
i	The traffic was very heavy *but / therefore / besides*, I was late for the movie.	**therefore**	late = result of heavy traffic
ii	*By the way / First of all / On top of that*, how are you faring with your fishery project?	**By the way**	casual change of topic
iii	*Eventually / Meanwhile / Since*, an old man answered the door after making repeated calls.	**Eventually**	after a long wait → at last
iv	We are so tired of the heavy lifting work, *on the other hand / in contrast to / what is more*, we do get good payment for it.	**on the other hand**	tiring (bad) vs good pay = contrast. *in contrast to* needs a noun after it.
v	*For the moment / Consequently / Since*, the hall was decorated with white roses as per the long discussion held over it.	**Consequently**	decoration = result of the discussion

2024 Q9(v) **I don't believe in ghosts. _____, I haven't seen one yet. A I think B At least C In particular D In other words [1]**

Answer: **B — At least** (limits the claim: "at the very least, I haven't seen one").

2024 Q9(vii) **The man was sleeping soundly under the tree. _____ a snake was creeping closer. A As a result, B Meanwhile, C By contrast, D Despite this, [1]**

Answer: **B — Meanwhile** (two events happening at the same time).

2025 Q5(x) **Which discourse marker indicates an outcome of a certain action? A As a result B For example C Furthermore D Nevertheless [1]**

Answer: **A — As a result** (shows outcome; B = example, C = addition, D = contrast).

Chapter 11: Parallelism, Word Order & Sentence Rearranging

2023 Q9 [5] · 2024 Q9(iii, iv) · 2024 Q8(ii) · 2025 Q9(9)

11.1 Must-know summary

Concept	Rule	Example
Parallelism	Items in a list or pair must have the **same grammatical form** (all -ing, all to-infinitives, all nouns, all adverbs).	Pema enjoys hiking, swimming and **riding** horses. • The doctor advised him **to stay** at home, **to take** proper medication and **to avoid** junk food. • finish reading the note **quickly and thoroughly** (adverb + adverb).
Basic word order	Subject + Verb + Object + Manner + Place + Time	She sold the books in the market last week.
Adverbs of frequency	before the main verb, after *be*	He **never** eats meat. / She is **always** late.
Negatives	did not / could not + base verb; negative adverb at the start → inversion	I could not attend. • **No longer** do we expect…
too + adjective + to + verb	shows an impossible result	He is **too weak to walk** without help.
Reported clause	verb + **that** + subject + verb	His mother complained **that the house was too hot**.
Because / since clause	can come at the end or the beginning	I could not attend the meeting **because** she was sick.

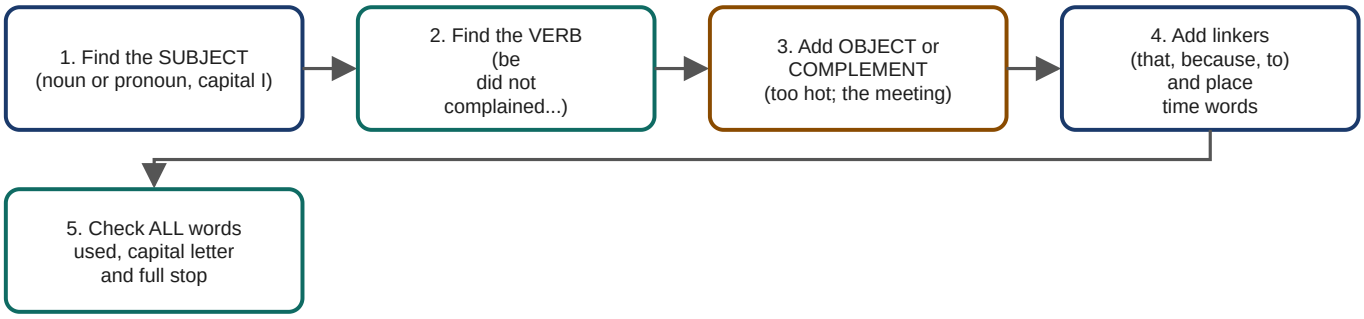


Fig 11.1 Step-by-step method for rearranging jumbled words

11.2 Solved questions

2023 Q9 **Rearrange the words to make complete sentences (use ALL the words; spelling is marked). [5]**

No.	Jumbled words	Sentence
i	was / his / complained / the / that / too / hot / house / mother	**His mother complained that the house was too hot.**
ii	without / to / walk / he / too / help / is / weak	**He is too weak to walk without help.**
iii	was / I / meeting / attend / the / not / because / she / sick / could	**I could not attend the meeting because she was sick.** (also correct: *Because she was sick, I could not attend the meeting.*)
iv	the / month / he / pay / membership / last / didn't / the / for / fee	**He didn't pay the membership fee for the last month.**
v	wailing / the / sounded / ominous / wind / an / warning / like	**The wailing wind sounded like an ominous warning.**

2024 Q9(iii) **The doctor advised him … A to stay home, taking proper medication and avoiding junk food. B staying home, to take proper medication and to avoid junk food. C to stay at home, to take proper medication and to avoid junk food. D to stay at home, to take proper medication and avoiding junk food. [1]**

Answer: **C** — only option where all three items are to-infinitives (*to stay, to take, to avoid*).

2024 Q9(iv) **I asked him to finish reading the note … A quickly and thoroughly. B quickly and in detailed manner. C as soon as possible and thoroughly. D soon as possible and to be as precise as it can be. [1]**

Answer: **A** — two adverbs in the same form. (B, C, D mix adverb, phrase and clause.)

Chapter 12: Cloze Passages (Fill in the Blanks)

2023 Q6 [5] (The White-bellied Heron) · 2024 Q6 [10] (A House on Fire) · 2025 Q6 [5] (verb forms)

12.1 Must-know summary

Step	What to do
1. Read the whole passage first	Understand the topic and the tense (past / present).
2. Identify the missing part of speech	noun? verb? preposition? adverb? article? linker?
3. Check the words around the blank	Collocations (*bring under control*, *gives cause for concern*, *known as*), prepositions (*join with hoses*), articles.
4. One word only; spell it correctly	Marks are deducted for spelling errors.
5. Re-read	Does the completed sentence sound natural and match the meaning?

Note on answers

Cloze blanks often accept **more than one** suitable word (e.g. *coming / shooting / leaping*). The first word below is the most natural choice; alternatives are shown in brackets.

12.2 Solved questions

2023 Q6 **The White-bellied Heron — fill each blank with ONE word. [5]**

The white-bellied heron, **found** in the freshwater ecosystems of the Himalayas, is the **most** endangered heron species in the world. Listed as critically endangered on the IUCN Red List since 2007, its total global population is estimated to be **between** 50–249 adult birds, and numbers are declining **even** further.

According to the conservation NGO BirdLife International, the species is **already** extinct in Nepal and possibly in Bangladesh too, with the **remaining** global population now restricted to northern Myanmar, northeast India and Bhutan.

Locally **known** as *chubja*, Bhutan is home to around 45–50% of the total global population of white-bellied herons, and the largest known number of breeding pairs. But a **recent** study gives cause for concern **for** the species in Bhutan too. In March 2021, 22 herons were recorded by RSPN, which was a decline by 5 **compared** with 27 birds in 2020.

Blank	Answer	Clue
1	found (also: living, native)	participle describing where the heron lives
2	most	superlative: the *most* endangered
3	between	estimated to be *between* 50–249 (a range)
4	even (also: rapidly, still)	"declining *even* further" (adverb of degree)
5	already (also: now, virtually)	extinct *already* in Nepal
6	remaining	the *remaining* population = what is left
7	known	locally *known* as
8	recent	a *recent* study (adjective before noun)

9	for (also: about, over)	cause for concern *for* the species
10	compared	decline by 5 *compared* with 27 in 2020

2024 Q6 **A House on Fire — fill each blank with ONE word. [10]**

I had never seen a house on fire **before**, so, one evening when I heard fire engines with loud alarm bells rushing past my house, I quickly ran out and joined a large **crowd** of people; but we could see the fire only from a distance because the police would not **allow** any one near the building on fire. What a terrible scene I saw that day! Huge flames of fire were **coming** out of each floor, and black and thick smoke **spread** all around.

Three fire engines were busily engaged and the rushing water from several hoses soaked the building, but it did not seem to have any **effect** on the flames. Then the tall red ladders of the fire engine were stretched upwards, and I could see some firemen climbing up **with** hoses in their hands. On **reaching** almost the top of the ladder, they began to pour floods of water on the topmost part of the building. This continuous flooding **brought** the fire under control, but the building was **completely** destroyed.

Blank	Answer	Clue
1	before	"never seen … *before*" (present perfect/past perfect)
2	crowd	a large *crowd* of people
3	allow (also: let, permit)	would not *allow* anyone near
4	coming (also: shooting, leaping, pouring)	flames *coming* out of each floor
5	spread (also: rose, billowed)	smoke *spread* all around (past tense)
6	effect (also: impact)	"have any *effect* on"
7	with	climbing up *with* hoses in their hands
8	reaching	"On *reaching*" = when they reached
9	brought	collocation: *brought the fire under control*
10	completely (also: badly, almost, totally)	adverb before *destroyed* ("but…" shows the building was still lost)

The 2025 Q6 verb-form passage is solved in Chapter 7.

Chapter 13: Sentence Transformation — Reported Speech, Passive Voice & Special Patterns

2025 Q7 [5] · 2025 Q5(vi)

13.1 Direct → Indirect (reported) speech

Change	Rule
Reporting verb	said (that) / told (someone) / asked / ordered / advised. Remove the quotation marks and add **that**.
Pronouns	I → he/she • we → they • my → his/her • our → their (changes according to the speaker and listener)
Tense (one step back)	if the reporting verb is in the past — see the diagram below.
Time & place words	now → then • today → that day • tomorrow → the next day • yesterday → the day before • here → there • this → that
Questions	asked + if/whether (yes/no) or wh-word + statement order (no inversion, no "?")
Commands	told/ordered/requested + person + (not) to + V1

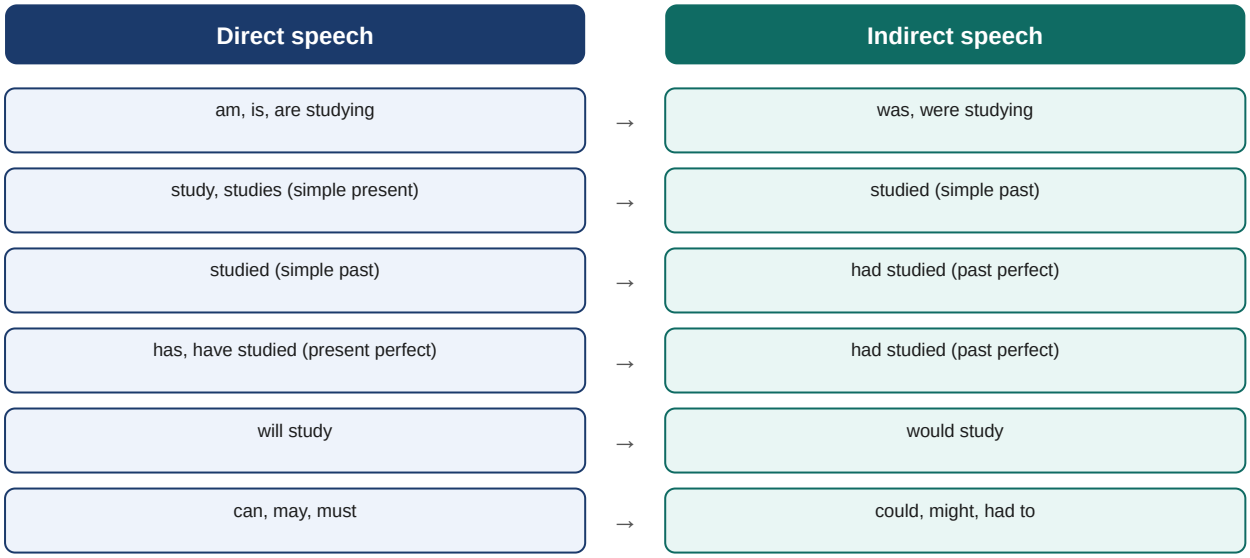


Fig 13.1 Tense changes in reported speech (backshift)

13.2 Active ↔ Passive voice

Tense	Passive formula	Active → Passive
Present simple	am/is/are + V3	Lizards eat insects. → Insects are eaten by lizards.
Past simple	was/were + V3	She wrote a letter. → A letter was written by her.
Present continuous	am/is/are **being** + V3	He is painting a wall. → A wall is being painted by him.
Past continuous	was/were **being** + V3	He **was playing** the flute. → The flute **was being played** by him. 2025 Q7(2)

Present perfect	has/have **been** + V3	They have built a dzong. → A dzong has been built by them.
Future simple	will **be** + V3	They will announce the result. → The result will be announced.
Modal verbs	modal + **be** + V3	You must finish it. → It must be finished.

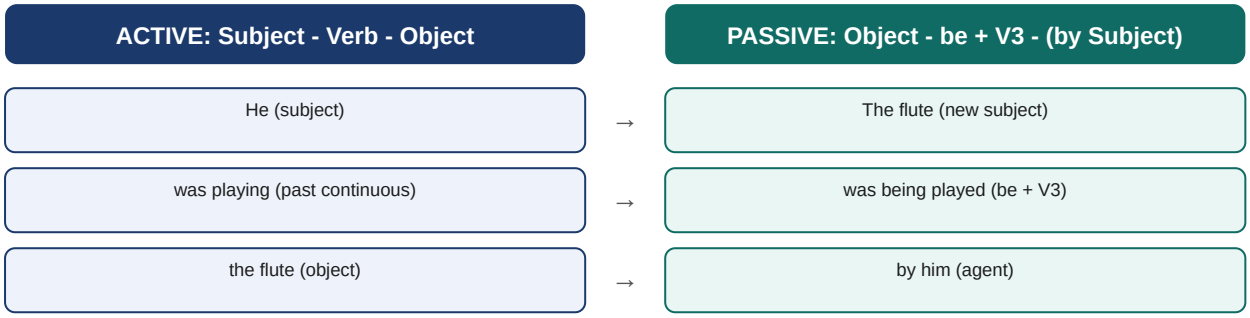


Fig 13.2 Active to passive: swap the object and the subject, change the verb

Other useful patterns	Structure & example
No sooner… than	No sooner **had** + subject + V3 + **than** + subject + V2 — *No sooner had the bell rung than the students rushed out.* (Same meaning: *Hardly had… when…*)
Although / though / even though	Although + clause, main clause (never use *but* in the same sentence) — *Although it rained, we played.*
Despite / in spite of	+ noun / V-ing: *Despite the rain, we played.*
Antonym rewrite	Replace the adjective with its opposite and keep the meaning with *not*: predictable → *not* unpredictable.
Not only… but also	Not only **did** she sing, but she also danced.
Unless	= if… not: *Unless you hurry, you will be late.*

13.3 Solved questions

2025 Q7 **Re-write the sentences according to the instructions in brackets. [5]**

No.	Given sentence	Answer
1	Sonam said, "I am studying for my exams." (Change into indirect speech)	**Sonam said that he/she was studying for his/her exams.** (am studying → was studying; I → he/she; my → his/her)
2	He was playing the flute. (Begin: The flute…)	**The flute was being played by him.**
3	As soon as the bell rang, the students rushed out of the classroom. (Use: No sooner…)	**No sooner had the bell rung than the students rushed out of the classroom.**
4	Zepa likes swimming. She doesn't like running. (Use: Although…)	**Although Zepa likes swimming, she doesn't like running.**
5	The ending of the novel was quite predictable. (Use an antonym of the adjective)	**The ending of the novel was not unpredictable.** (or: …was hardly unpredictable)

2025 Q5(vi) **"Most lizards rely on camouflage to hide from their enemies." Which sentence is its passive form? A Camouflage is relied on by most lizards… B Camouflage was relied on… C Camouflage has been relied on… D Camouflage has been relied upon… [1]**

Answer: **A** — the original is simple **present**, so the passive is **is + V3** (*is relied on*). B is past, C and D are present perfect.

Chapter 14: Vocabulary, Crosswords & Grammar MCQs

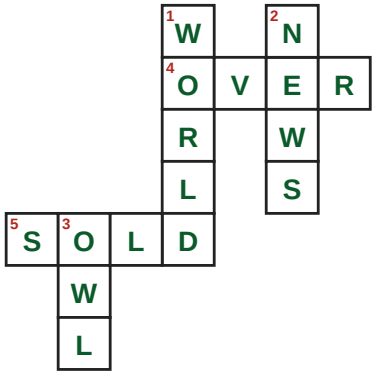
2023 Q8 [5] · 2024 Q10 [5] · 2025 Q8 [5] · 2024 Q9 [10] · 2025 Q5 [10]

14.1 Crossword puzzles (read the clue, count the boxes, check the crossing letters)

How to solve

1) Count the boxes — the answer must fit exactly. 2) Start with the clue you are sure about. 3) Use crossing letters to confirm or fix the others. 4) Spell correctly — marks are lost for spelling.

2023 Q8 **Crossword: DOWN 1. Wow! The song is out of this ____! 2. Dorji hasn't broken the ____ to his mother yet. 3. Pem is a night ____. ACROSS 4. When Ngawang was done and ____ with the singing competition… 5. The book was already ____ out. [5]**

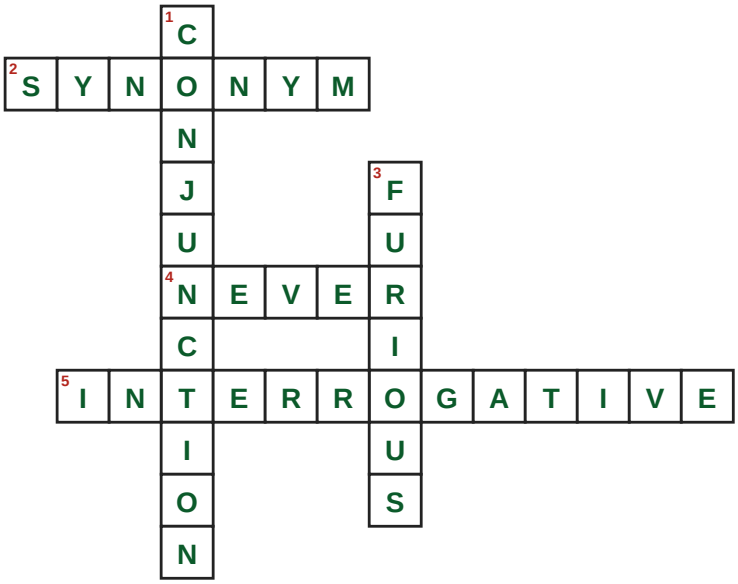


2023 Q8 crossword solved: 1 WORLD (down) 2 NEWS (down) 3 OWL (down) 4 OVER (across) 5 SOLD (across)

Clue	Answer	Check
1 down	**WORLD**	5 boxes; "out of this world" (excellent)
2 down	**NEWS**	4 boxes; "break the news"; 2nd letter E crosses OVER
3 down	**OWL**	3 boxes; starts with the O of SOLD
4 across	**OVER**	4 boxes; "done and over with"; starts with the O of WORLD
5 across	**SOLD**	4 boxes; ends with the D of WORLD

2025 Q8 **Crossword clues: 1 A word that connects words, phrases or clauses (down) · 2 A word meaning the same as another word (across) · 3 A word meaning the same as "angry" (down) · 4 Opposite of "Always" (across) · 5 Type**

of sentence that asks a question (across). [5]



2025 Q8 crossword solved: 1 CONJUNCTION (down) 2 SYNONYM (across) 3 FURIOUS (down) 4 NEVER (across) 5 INTERROGATIVE (across)

Clue	Answer	Check
1 down	**CONJUNCTION**	11 boxes; and, but, because…
2 across	**SYNONYM**	7 boxes; its 4th letter O is the 2nd letter of CONJUNCTION
3 down	**FURIOUS**	7 boxes; 3rd letter R is the last letter of NEVER; 5th letter O is in INTERROGATIVE
4 across	**NEVER**	5 boxes; starts with the 6th letter (N) of CONJUNCTION
5 across	**INTERROGATIVE**	13 boxes; 3rd letter T is the 8th letter of CONJUNCTION

14.2 Word scrambles (anagrams) — Animal Kingdom vocabulary

2024 Q10 **Rearrange the mixed letters to form words related to the ANIMAL KINGDOM. [5]**

No.	Hint	Mixed letters	Answer
Ex	seasonal movement of animals	MTOIGRNIA	MIGRATION
i	natural home of an organism	TTHIAAB	**HABITAT**
ii	living organisms change gradually over time	ONVOTUILE	**EVOLUTION**
iii	variety of life in a habitat/ecosystem	OIIVBDYISRTE	**BIODIVERSITY**
iv	animal that hunts other animals for food	RPREDAOT	**PREDATOR**
v	organism that makes its own food by photosynthesis	PHRTOOUAT	**AUTOTROPH**

Related words to learn: prey, herbivore, carnivore, omnivore, ecosystem, food chain, camouflage, hibernation, nocturnal, extinct, endangered, conservation, adaptation, species, survival.

14.3 Grammar MCQ concepts

Concept	Rule	Example
Gerund	V-ing used as a **noun** (subject/object)	**Painting** landscapes allows me to express my creativity.
Modifier	adjective/adverb that describes another word	The **furry** puppy (furry modifies puppy)
Simple sentence	one independent clause (can have a compound subject/predicate)	She enjoys painting and playing the guitar.
Compound sentence	two independent clauses joined by and/but/so	The bus arrived late, so he missed the movie.
Complex sentence	independent + dependent clause	Although it rained, we played.
Question tag	positive statement → negative tag; negative → positive; same auxiliary & subject as pronoun. No auxiliary → do/does/did.	Good people speak well of others, **don't they?**
Double negative	two negatives cancel each other — use one negative + *any*	He didn't accept **any** suggestions. (~~didn't see nothing~~)
Pronoun agreement	"each / everyone / every" is singular → his or her + singular noun	Each of the students brought **his or her** own textbook.
Correlatives	both…and • either…or • neither…nor • not only…but also • whether…or not	This salad is **both** delicious **and** healthy.
whether / if	use *whether* after prepositions and before *to*-infinitive or *or not*	a decision about **whether** to go
Negative inversion	No longer / Never / Rarely / Hardly … + auxiliary + subject	**No** longer do we expect…

14.4 Solved MCQs

2025 Q5 **Circle ONE answer. [10]**

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	She ____ definitely like it! (can/will/may/could)	**B will**	certainty (Ch 7)
ii	Identify the gerund: "Painting landscapes allows me to express my creativity."	**B painting**	V-ing acting as the subject noun
iii	"hit the book" means	**D**	immerse oneself in academic study (Ch 9)
iv	Good people speak well of others, ____	**B don't they?**	positive statement → negative tag; plural subject *people* → *they*
v	closest meaning of **guarantee**	**D promise**	"guarantee" = give a firm promise
vi	passive of "Most lizards rely on camouflage…"	**A**	present simple passive (Ch 13)
vii	Which is a simple sentence?	**A**	one clause: "She enjoys painting and playing the guitar." B, C, D are compound
viii	Sentence with **incorrect** pronoun usage	**C**	"Each… brought <u>their</u> own textbook" — *each* is singular, so *his or her* (as in D)
ix	Sentence that avoids a double negative	**D**	"didn't accept <u>any</u>" — A, B, C have two negatives
x	Discourse marker for an outcome	**A As a result**	Ch 10

2024 Q9 **Circle ONE answer. [10]**

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
i	Identify the modifier: *The furry puppy was bouncing around.*	**D furry**	adjective that describes the noun *puppy*
ii	The ____ provided a beautiful ____ of the valley.	**C site, sight**	Ch 5
iii	The doctor advised him…	**C**	parallel to-infinitives (Ch 11)
iv	finish reading the note…	**A**	quickly and thoroughly — parallel adverbs
v	I don't believe in ghost. ____, I haven't seen one yet.	**B At least**	Ch 10
vi	It is snowing outside, so I ____ stay at home.	**C will**	Ch 7
vii	The man was sleeping soundly… ____ a snake was creeping closer.	**B Meanwhile**	Ch 10
viii	There was a time when I ____ stay up very late.	**B could**	Ch 7
ix	Have you made a decision about ____ to go to the movies or not?	**D whether**	preposition + whether + to… or not
x	This salad is ____ delicious and healthy.	**B both**	correlative *both…and*

2023 Q5 **Circle ONE answer (items not solved in earlier chapters). [5]**

No.	Question	Answer	Reason
iii	The principal accepted the class' proposal for a field trip to the dzong. He was happy that students were interested in their country's ____.	**D history**	a dzong is a historic monument — interest in the country's *history*
iv	____ longer do we expect the trespassers to tell us why they were in the property.	**D No**	"No longer do we expect" — negative inversion

Last-Minute Revision Sheet

English I — everything on one page

Topic	Remember
Essay	Title + 5 paragraphs (intro with thesis, 3 body with topic sentence + example, conclusion). 350–400 words. Bhutanese examples. No personal details.
Letter	Sender's address • date • receiver's address • Dear Sir/Madam • subject • 3 paragraphs • Yours faithfully • name. Cover EVERY point in the question.
Report	Headline • by-line • dateline • 5Ws+H in paragraph 1 • past tense/passive • facts only • use all given data • 180–200 words.
Table to paragraphs	Introduce → group data by category → compare (rose/fell/whereas) → overall trend. ≤150 words.
Subject–verb agreement	head noun decides • each/every = singular • neither…nor = nearer subject • as well as doesn't add • group = singular.
Verbs	modal + V1 • will + base • did not + base • be + V3 (passive) • mixed conditional: if + had V3, would + V1.
Parallelism	to…, to…, to… • -ing, -ing, -ing • adverb + adverb.
Discourse markers	result = therefore/consequently/as a result • contrast = however/on the other hand • addition = moreover/besides • time = eventually/meanwhile • topic = by the way.
Phrasal verbs & idioms	Read the whole sentence; match the meaning, not the words.
Cloze	Part of speech → collocation → spelling.
Transformation	reported speech: back-shift tense and pronouns • passive: object becomes subject • No sooner had… than • Although + clause, clause.
Always	Read the instruction twice • circle ONE option • check spelling • correct only the error • leave no blank.